

Jessica Alba Dynasty League – 2022 Season Preview

1. Introduction

Welcome to the third year of our dynasty league. After an eventful 2021 season I know that we're all eager for the kick-off of the NFL season and the fantasy adventure that accompanies it.

I'd like to congratulate Dave on his victory for the last time and wish you all almost the best of luck for the season ahead. At least we don't have to worry about Dave gloating for at least another 12 months given the sorry state of his side and conference.

Of course, this year is the season that establishes the Lombardi and Madden Conferences. Inner conference rivalries will begin with some larger rivalries to be established between the eventual championship finalists. Much like the AFC and NFC there's clearly one conference with significantly more talent than the other. In fact, it's rather more like the AFC West vs NFC North. Maybe the LFC will get better with all those high draft picks they'll have next year?

There are ample stats on our website and on Sleeper so I won't go as heavily into these as before but I have included a couple of metrics about what the often-maligned experts think now and did they get it right on the whole last season.

2. The Commandos (Gareth - LFC) – 10th Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
91	4 th (4 th)	9 th (-5)	10 th (-6)	71 (-20)	9 th	9 th

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
5 th	=7 th	9 th	=5 th	7 th	=7 th	5 th	=8 th

Last season's Loser of All Losers finds himself very much in a similar place in terms of projections this year. With a rebranded team comes a rebranded GM. Gone are the days of the 'No Trade' policy and with what looks like firm sights set on 2023 and beyond he's set up nicely with those two early 2023 firsts. All that being said, with no perceivable changes to the starting line-up from those he drafted, it's still looking a bit stagnant for The 'Mandos. So let's take a look at the team that won't be improved.

Four starting QBs is a great start. Tannehill providing that consistency and Wentz at yet another new team and a starting job. Very much like The 'Mandos, Mr Unlimited has changed his brand and with that will he finally be able to boom beyond the first half of a season? An unlikely starter in Mariota backs up his three main men. Is there a possible trade target here for a team short of a QB?

Gareth's RB core is getting older every year but sadly not improving. He has Javonte Williams an RB2 unless he finally stops sharing that workload with Gordon, then three semi-reliable RB3s in CEH, Miles Sanders and Singletary. Beyond that? A lot of hope and dreams. It's not a championship winning lineup.

Gareth's WR core again looks solid and semi-reliable. Two WR2s and a couple of WR4s will feature in most weeks for Gareth. All the model of consistency and reliability but not much in terms of championship winning difference makers.

If you want a difference maker then he has that potential at TE. Darren Waller had a tremendous 2020 campaign and in a team in the AFC West which will need to pass a lot, could look to bounce back in 2022 after disappointing last year. Not much in the way of backup though.

He has planned pretty well with no significant bye week clashes.

I can see now why Gareth has felt there is no need for changes. Continue in that negative spiral in the hope that he can get one or more of those top picks from that juicy 2023 draft class.



3. Falcons (Chris - MFC) – 9th Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
77	8 th (7 th)	10 th (-2)	9 th (-1)	88 (+11)	4 th	5 th

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
4 th	4 th	2 nd	=5 th	9 th	6 th	6 th	=5 th

Last season's projected eighth place finisher finds himself a higher in the projections this year thanks to his off-season trading. He's given up his next three first round picks for Drake London and Kyler Murray, boosting the QB and WR wings of his ~~prison~~ team.

At QB Chris has bolstered this area of his team to 4 starters, two of which should be lock-in QB1s this year. He's backed up by someone who should be spending more time improving his game than chasing after his mum's friends and, later on in the season, DeShaun Watson, assuming he can keep his tiny towel to himself in Cleveland.

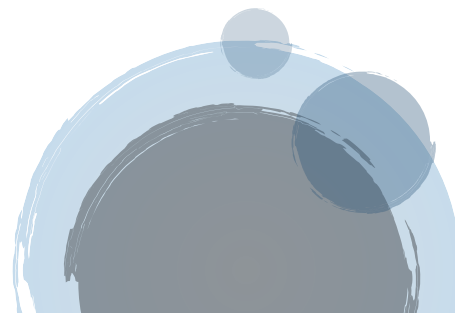
Chris has one of the stronger starting RB cores, with both RB1s capable of being the RB1. After that he's got a man coming back from what is usually a career ending injury and a series of backups. *If* his top two men can stay fit then he won't worry too much as they should help him sail into the playoffs.

Chris has one of the weaker WR cores. It's not all bad though. Led out by a late WR1, three WR3s and two WR4s. He's going to need some breakouts to see him through the season to a championship.

In what is now a common story, Chris' team has a decent starer in Dalton Schutz but nothing of significance to back that up. Do we know if Geno Smith likes targeting TEs?

Chris has planned fairly well with his most significant bye week clashes coming in weeks 9 (vs Dave), and 10 (vs Gareth). He has a full-strength side available in week 12 against Jebus.

There is the potential for another run to the playoffs if he can keep his studs fit or find some depth to be competitive over a long season. If he can buy a ticket, he can win it but will sacrificing his team his team until 2026 be the solution to finally make a run at that championship?



4. J J F J (Lee - MFC) – 8th Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
90	5 th (6 th)	8 th (-3)	8 th (-3)	100 (+10)	1 st	3 rd

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
6 th	=5 th	4 th	=1 st	1 st	=1 st	4 th	=2 nd

We move onto an early rebuild who finds themselves now atop of projections. Only two starters remain from his draft and there are not many more on his bench. Is it because his draft was incredibly poor or because he's making moves to win now with no future firsts until 2025? Let's have a closer look.

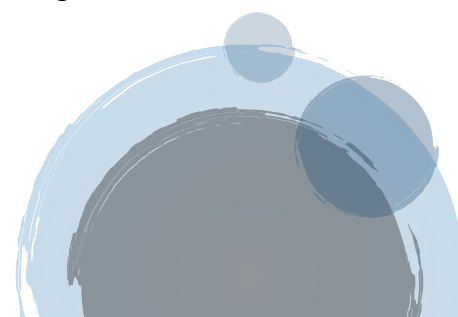
Lee's QB core is by far the weakest area of his team. We'll see later examples of the inverse and the power that has. He does have the much-hyped Trey Lance who is projected to be a QB1 but this is very much a projection given his complete inexperience at the position and Jimmy G waiting in the wings should he do a Daniel Jones and slip up. Beyond that, three QB2s; two consistent performers in Derek Carr and newly acquired Matt Ryan and, a one-legged Jameis Winston. Consistency mixed with youthful upside could be a winning formula but it's a big gamble not to have an established QB1 leading into a highly competitive MFC.

From what was a disaster zone, his RB room is now an area of strength. His leading RB Josh Jacobs is now his fifth RB with Ekeler leading his corps. Behind that are three RB2s which gives him some decent depth when injuries inevitably hit.

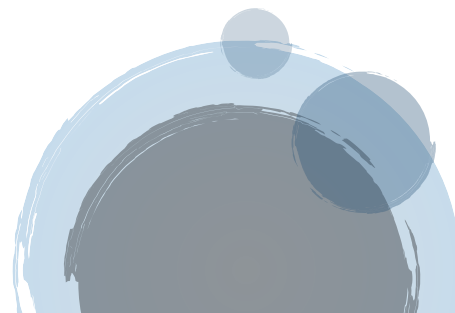
His WRs are the heart and soul of his team with his young and exciting WRs, both top tier WR1s, pushing him to the No 1 ranked spot and making up the core of his weekly selections. Behind them are a WR2 and then three WR4s. There's a lot of strength here but perhaps not the depth he has at QB and RB.

Similar to both the previous teams, Lee has a solid TE but perhaps not one who can provide a weekly positional advantage. Perhaps he should've kept Travis Kelce if he was serious about a championship run this year?

He has planned pretty well with perhaps two concerning bye weeks at 9 and 14, against Jebus and Neil, respectively.



Lee's team is certainly one of the stronger sides for this year and perhaps beyond. He's also invested heavily in this team without any first-round picks until 2025. Has the perfect plan come together or will difficulties at QB or an injury to one of those brilliant WRs derail his first shot of being a contender?



5. Kittle-less Chips (Alex - LFC) – 7th Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
100	1 st (2 nd)	7 th (-6)	7 th (-6)	40 (-60)	10 th	10 th

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
10 th	10 th	10 th	10 th	10 th	10 th	8 th	10 th

Last season's projected winner experienced a rather unfortunate 2021 campaign which could've been salvaged by winning the 1.01 had he not traded it to Ross. Since then, there's been a fire sale which has created a record low power ranking of 40 from 100 last year. What a difference a year has made! Has he cut too deep though?

Technically, Alex has 3 QBs but in reality one is retired and the other two are competing for one rather bad job. It will come as no surprise that he is ranked bottom of the pile here. One can only assume that plethora of 2023 and 2024 firsts will be used to draft some QBs. He'll need to find another starter for this year though or maybe one of those first round picks will be removed as the punishment for not having a full line-up in week 11?

A similar story at RB with Alex's side ranking dead last, with three RB3s likely sharing the starter duties. Beyond that some dart-throws/backups beyond that. More of those firsts are going to be needed here to be able to compete again.

Very much in line with his QBs and RBs, Alex has a very poor WR core. He has two WR2s in his starting slots, an injured WR3 and then a load of dross. Yet more demand on those 8 firsts in the next three drafts.

It's not quite as bad at the TE position. This is mainly because, outside of the top few TEs, it's all a gamble at TE.

He has also planned well with bye week clashes, with a full-strength squad available in week 12 against Dave. However, Week 11 features no QBs which needs sorting otherwise a suitable punishment will be needed to make an example of such poor management and disruption to the integrity of the league.

From what was an abundance of starting quality and depth in most positions, Alex has turned his team on its head. He's got some value back in terms of picks but this year will be a lost year for Kittle-less Chips. The question is how many lost years will there be before he can start making a run at getting the 1.01, nevermind that coveted belt.

6. Canton Giants (Neil - MFC) – 6th Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
73	9 th (10 th)	4 th (+5)	6 th (+3)	71 (-2)	8 th	8 th

QB		RB		WR		TE	
ECR	JR™	ECR	JR™	ECR	JR™	ECR	JR™
9 th	9 th	5 th	=7 th	2 nd	=1 st	10 th	=8 th

It was a relatively successful 2021 for Neil and his Giants and if the predictions are anything to go by it'll be another yoyo as he ends up back in the race for the 1.01. He bucked those predications last year but will he do it again? At least he's stopped making so many crazy trades with Dave – maybe that was the key to his success last year?

Neil must continue to be concerned with his QB core. He has three starters but only one of those is a top 24 QB. The other two are just about still in a job and will find themselves out of one if they don't have seriously good years. Does he still rue he passing up on Trey Lance, Mac Jones or even Zach Wilson at the 2021 rookie draft?

Neil's RB core is an improvement on his QB room. Similar to Chris, Neil boasts two RB1s in Najee Harris and the legally dubious Kamara. After that there is a bit of drop off in quality but perhaps Darrel Henderson can take advantage of Cam Akers' Achilles problems?

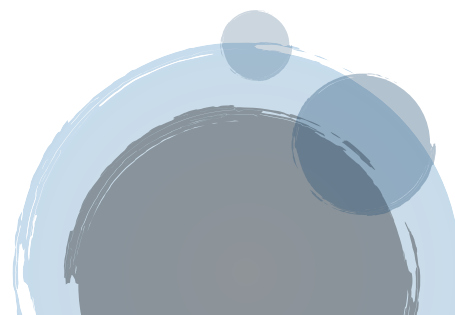
In stark contrast to the rest of his team Neil's WRs are up there with the best. With two WR1s, a WR2 and a WR3 making up his viable starters it's certainly one of the better cores in the league. If the triple crown champion has another great season he could well find himself back in the playoffs and who knows what could happen if he gets that lottery ticket.

Neil's team, like so many, suffers from the dearth of quality at the TE position. With two TE2s he'll be hoping that he picks the right one when streaming them.

Unfortunately, and in part due to his QBs sharing the same bye week, there are two significant bye week clashes in weeks 6 and 7 against Dave and Mike, respectively. He's a full squad for week 12 against Dudders though.

Outside of his WRs it looks likely to be another tough season for Neil. There's certainly some hope if his RBs can stay fit but would his team be better served in the long-run with the choice of rookies at this year's rookie draft, particularly with several QBs available. Given the relative strength of the

MFC, Neil has an outside chance of making the playoffs is possible but could do his team more harm than good. Is it time to trade in those better and older assets for more youth and future picks?



7. One Flew of the Rookies Nest (Ross - MFC) – 5th Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
66	10 th (=8 th)	3 rd (+7)	5 th (+5)	80 (+14)	5 th	4 th

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
1 st	=2 nd	7 th	=7 th	6 th	=7 th	1 st	=2 nd

Now for one of just two teams to make the playoffs every year since the league's inception. The man has a keen eye for rookies and is often assisted with an enormous dollop of luck but did that luck run out when he was drawn in the MFC? At one point in the off-season I thought he was rebuilding but then he bought Travis Kelce for a '23 first and second. So what to make of this team in flux?

Last year I asked how you can win a superflex league with only two QBs. At least he has three this year. My word two of those starters are good – both QB1s with years of production ahead of them. Beyond that – could be better, has been worse. Baker will be looking to resurrect his career in Carolina but Ross will be hoping he spends most of his time on his bench.

Ross' RB core is surrounded by uncertainty and that's reflected in their value. Two RB2s and two RB3s will be the core he is relying on but with the main two not catching any passes it really limits their season long upside.

Similar to his RB core, it's ranked middle of the pack. As always young and productive but not all gracing the top of the tree. A WR1, two WR3s and a WR4 are his main options then a whole load of hope.

In contrast, the aforementioned Travis Kelce will once again look to be *the* TE1 after being surpassed by Mark Andrews last year. Beyond that, a couple of decent options but does that really matter when you have Mahomes' favourite target?

Surely he's planned well for bye week clashes? Alas, with a famine of depth he's going to be looking at lower tier replacements in weeks 8 (vs Dave), 9 (vs Neil) and 10 (vs Neil). However, he has a fully fit team in week 12 against Lee.

With the moves he's made, Ross will be looking to compete this year. With QBs like that, why wouldn't you be. But will the rest of his team hold up against some very good teams in the MFC?



8. Tompa Bay Bucs (Mike - LFC) – 4th Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
83	7 th (5 th)	2 nd (+5)	4 th (+3)	90 (+7)	3 rd	1 st

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
2 nd	=2 nd	1 st	=1 st	3 rd	=4 th	3 rd	1 st

Mike bucked the projections last year and finished the regular season in second, breaking Ross' points record in the process, but falling short in the playoffs. This year is different though. He's firmly in the top three and has quality across the positional groups and is lacking quality competition from the rest of the LFC.

With one of the strongest QB lineups, Mike can boast the QB3 and 6. However, beyond this he's not looking so hot. Will Tua breakout this year with that new offensive philosophy and weapons? An early injury to his top two could cause issues during the bye weeks as he has no one beyond Tua. Mike had the choice of several highly regarded QBs at the 2021 Rookie Draft. Would his team look better with Tray Lance, Zach Wilson or even Mac Jones rather than the \$732 man as backups?

Mike has three stout starting RBs, with two RB1s and an RB2 most likely regularly featuring this season. After those three there's a bit of a drop to an RB3 (plus future Hall of Famer, Dameon Pierce) then a wasteland beyond. Mike's hopes seemingly sit on the shoulders of Jonathan Fucking Taylor. Not bad shoulders to put them on, unless he gets injured.

If there is a weakness to Mike's team it's his WR core. It's all relative though. He has two WR1s, a WR2 but then its two WR4s then a whole load of nothing? Is this the chink in Mike's well assembled team's armour?

The future is Kyle Pitts but is the future now or will it take the Falcons a bit longer to utilise their unicorn TE to full effect. Mike must be worried that their QB is Mariota. He does have another TE1 as a backup though but will it be enough for a positional advantage when it matters again?

He has planned pretty well with two fairly significant bye week clashes: week 7 (vs Neil) and the likely irrelevant to Mike week 14 (vs Jebus).

Mike's certainly got the quality in every position group to make a play for the belt. He's got a stranglehold over the LFC but does iron sharpen iron and when it comes to facing the MFC, will his team fall short again?

9. Raiders of the Lost Yard (Jebus - MFC) – 3rd Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
96	2 nd (1 st)	1 st (+1)	3 rd (-1)	90 (-6)	2 nd	2 nd

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
3 rd	1 st	6 th	3 rd	5 th	3 rd	2 nd	4 th

After a record-breaking regular season, Jebus' team fell short in the playoffs losing again to Dave when it mattered. Does his team still hold up to last year's regular season dominance or has the championship window closed on his side?

From what was a relative weakness, thanks to more selling of future assets and Tom Brady deciding not to retire, his QB room is now a relative strength. Jebus has three QB1s so one injury and bye weeks will not be a problem this year. However, several injuries could be a problem as his depth beyond them is none existent....unless Jalen Hurts gets injured.

The same as last year, Jebus boasts three RB1s but this area of the team possibly carries the greatest risk: Saquon had to have one of his knees reconstructed then his ankle turned into a balloon and Aaron Jones has AJ Dillon breathing down his neck. He does have Rashod Penny as a backup but relying on him playing more than five full games seems unlikely. Beyond that an absolute wasteland. The very definition of wafer thin.

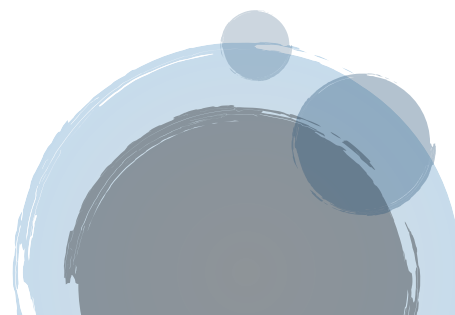
Jebus' WR core has taken a bit of a step back mainly due to his players having new teams and/or QBs to build relationships with. Saying that he still has two WR1s, two WR2s and two WR3s. Nothing to be sniffed at but his MFC competitors are hot on his heels in this area.

Having last year's TE1 who has even less target competition could again give Jebus some weekly positional advantage. However, his depth is skin deep and an injury to Andrews could derail his season.

He has some significant bye week clashes in weeks 9 (vs Lee), 10 (vs Lee again!) and 11 (vs Ross). He has a full side available in week 12 against Chris, though.

Like Tom Brady, Jebus may feel he has some unfinished business. But like Brady his team isn't getting any younger with other teams in his conference waiting for him to slip up. If you look at the starters there is a league winning team with potential top scorers in Lamar, Brady, Dak, Jones, Saquon, Hill,

Deebo and Andrews. He's certainly pushed his chips in again for this year but what will he do to compete in 2023 and 2024?



10. Inch by Inch (Dudders - LFC) – 2nd Place

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
85	6 th (8 th)	6 th (-)	2 nd (+4)	74 (-11)	7 th	6 th

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
8 th	=5 th	8 th	=7 th	4 th	=4 th	7 th	=5 th

There's quite a similarity between Gareth's team in year one and Dudders in year two. Runner up and continuing the 'No Trade Experiment' could be a recipe for disaster. Will Dudders fortunes differ? Projections wise it looks like it may be another middling year but as last season goes to show, if you get a ticket you could win it all.

Much like Neil, there is probably some concern with his QB core ranked so low but with three QB2s it ain't all bad, certainly when one is a back-to-back MVP! Beyond that there is some uncertainty if there are any long-term starters. How long until Tribisky is supplanted by Kenny Pickett?

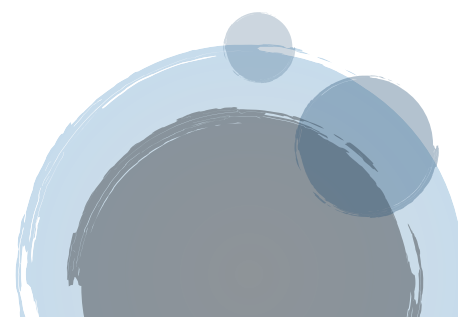
Dudders will be glad that he's avoided the bad luck to befall his RB room as last pre-season. Cam Akers is back and we'll find out if you can recover from an Achilles injury. Added to Cam are two further RB2s and an RB3. Nothing to be sniffed and plenty of upside.

The highlight of Dudders team is surely his WRs led by his two WR1s: Devonte Adams and AJ Brown. After that he has a WR2 then two WR5s. It's a solid core with a hatful of youth.

As with many teams, Dudders' team suffers from the dearth of quality at the TE position. He does have a TE1 in the mix then a few TEs which would make great additions to a bestball lineup. A trade or massive breakout is needed here to be competitive on a weekly basis.

He has planned fairly well with bye weeks but his problems are all combined into the crucial week 14 clash against Alex.

There are a range of outcomes for Mr D where all of his players stay fit and he makes another run in the playoffs. There is another possibility where he repeats Gareth's mistakes and he takes the Golden Turd off the present Loser of All Losers.



11. Mac to the Future (Dave - LFC) – Champion

2021				2022		
Power Ranking	Prediction ECR (JR™)	Regular Season Finish	Overall Finish	Power Ranking	Prediction	Jebus Ranking™
94	3 rd (3 rd)	5 th (-2)	1 st (+2)	77 (-17)	6 th	7 th

QB		RB		WR		TE	
FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™	FP	JR™
7 th	=7 th	3 rd	4 th	8 th	=7 th	9 th	=5 th

Last but not least is the man who went from the Trevor Trophy winner to Championship Belt holder. It gives us all hope. He was ranked as a top 3 team last year though, but some ‘interesting’ trading has shifted this down to mid table. At least he’s in the LFC so he may still make the playoffs again. Does his team have what it takes to be the first to retain the belt? Let’s see

At QB Dave has 3 starters led by the lone and only just QB1, Matthew Stafford. The quality behind him has a lot of potential but some uncertainty. Will Trevor become the player he was drafted to be now unshackled from Urban Meyers? Is Mac Jones any good? Should he have traded Dak for Jimmy G?

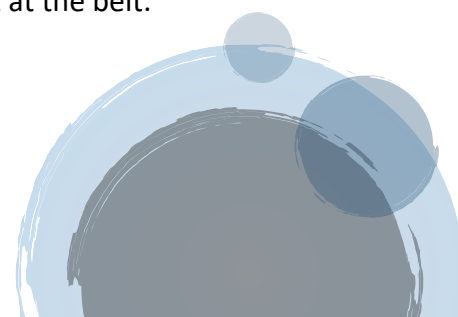
With two RB1s backed up by one RB2 then a RB4 and RB5, Dave arguably has one of the strongest RB cores in the league. Previously his strength at RB was consistency and depth but lacking the absolute stud backs that often feature in weekly and league winning lineups. Now he seems to have reversed that trend despite it actually being a winning formula for him.

If you’re looking for a weakness in his team, WR may be it. Two WR2s, three WR3s and a whole load of hope. If his team was in the MFC it would have no hope. As he’s in the LFC it should be enough but will it be enough to push his team to glory again?

Another potential weakness is Dave’s TEs. He has a load of them but are any of them any good? He’s living on a wing and a prayer here but some sensible/lucky streaming could keep him afloat.

He has also planned pretty well with weeks 9 and 13 bye week (against Chris and Ross) potentially being a bit of an issue. He has a full-strength squad available in week 12 against Alex.

With a fall in quality and depth in the two most differentiating positions, Dave is certainly going into the season weaker than last year. He should make the playoffs this year thanks to the creation of conferences and with a good serving of luck could be a dark horse with a shot at the belt.



12. Conclusion

Well done for making it this far. May I be the first to congratulate Mike on his winning the belt.

Don't take what I've said too much to heart. What do I know? Maybe do take my rankings a bit more to heart than the experts but given both levels of inaccuracy I would take them with a pinch of salt. There's still time now and in season to change your fortunes – whether that's to win this year or beyond.

In any case, enjoy the highs and lows of another Dynasty season and remember: in the end there can be only one.